

# **“The Self-Aware Parent Journal” – Episode #10 Parent Resource**

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## **Why Self-Awareness Matters**

Our teens are not mirrors of our expectations; they are reflections of our emotional world.

Parental self-awareness — the ability to pause, notice, and respond consciously — is one of the greatest gifts we can offer. Research from Harvard’s Center on the Developing Child (2023) highlights that parental emotional regulation directly influences a child’s stress response and resilience.

When parents act from awareness instead of impulse, they model balance, trust, and accountability — all vital life skills for teens.

### **Quote:**

**“Children become what you are; so be what you want them to become.” — David Bly**

### **Reflection Thought:**

Every time you respond, your teen learns how to respond to life.



# Self-Reflection Prompts

**Take a few minutes daily this week to write short, honest answers to these:**

1. When my teen resists my advice, what emotion does it trigger in me — frustration, fear, rejection, or helplessness?
2. Do I sometimes confuse helping with controlling?
3. What is one pattern from my own upbringing that I may be unconsciously repeating?
4. When my teen makes mistakes, do I react from fear or respond with faith?
5. What is one quality in my teen I often overlook because I'm focused on their performance?

 **Tip: Write, don't type. The act of handwriting slows your thoughts and deepens reflection.**



# The Awareness Shift (Mini Case Study)

## Case Study:

Arunita, a working mother of a 15-year-old, noticed that her son Aarav grew defensive whenever she checked his homework.

At first, she thought he was being disrespectful.

But during a reflection exercise, she realized she was driven by her fear of failure — that Aarav's missed assignment would reflect poorly on her as a parent.

She decided to replace control with coaching.

Instead of saying, "Did you finish your homework?", she began asking,

"What's your plan to finish your homework tonight?"

Two weeks later, Aarav started self-monitoring his schedule — and even shared his progress with pride.

## Lesson:

Awareness transforms tension into trust.



# The 5-Day Awareness Practice Plan

**A simple daily exercise to strengthen mindful parenting habits.**

## **Day 1: Observe without reacting**

Watch how you typically respond when your teen resists. Note the triggers.

## **Day 2: Name your emotion**

Label what you feel — irritation, worry, guilt, fear. Naming reduces intensity.

## **Day 3: Reframe your intent**

Ask yourself: “Am I trying to control or to connect?” Shift toward connection.

## **Day 4: Practice presence**

When your teen talks, listen fully. Don’t fix or advise immediately.

## **Day 5: Acknowledge growth**

Appreciate both your own awareness and your teen’s small steps toward responsibility.

